

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy

Expected In July 2028

The University of Sydney

Adviser: Associate Professor Anusha Withana

Department: Computer Science (Human Computer Interaction)

Bachelor of Advanced Computing (Honours)

2019 - 2024

The University of Sydney

Honours Class I

Honours Subject Area: Human Computer Interaction

Major: Information Systems (Engineering)

Bachelor of Commerce

2019 - 2024

The University of Sydney

Major: Business Information Systems

PUBLICATIONS

Yihao Dong, Praneeth Bimsara Perera, Chin-Teng Lin, Craig T Jin, and Anusha Withana. 2026. TactDeform: Finger Pad Deformation Inspired Spatial Tactile Feedback for Virtual Geometry Exploration. In *Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '26)*, April 13–17, 2026, Barcelona, Spain. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 16 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3791699>

Yihao Dong, Pamuditha Somarathne, Craig Jin, Juno Kim, Andrea Bianchi, and Anusha Withana. 2025. Just Before Touch: Manipulating Perceived Haptic Sensations through Proactive Vibrotactile Cues in Virtual Reality. In *Proceedings of Augmented Humans International Conference (AHs '25)*. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 13 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3745900.3746097>

Hongyu Zhou, Chia-An Fan, **Yihao Dong**, Shuto Takashita, Masahiko Inami, Zhanna Sarsenbayeva, and Anusha Withana. 2026. SRL Proxemics: Spatial Guidelines for Supernumerary Robotic Limbs in Near-Body Interactions. In *Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '26)*, April 13–17, 2026, Barcelona, Spain. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 22 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3790532>

Hongyu Zhou, Tom Kip, **Yihao Dong**, Andrea Bianchi, Zhanna Sarsenbayeva, and Anusha Withana. 2025. Juggling Extra Limbs: Identifying Control Strategies for Supernumerary Multi-Arms in Virtual Reality. In *Proceedings of the 2025CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25), April 26–May 01, 2025, Yokohama, Japan*. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 16 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3706598.3713647> **[Honorable Mention – Top 5%]**

Hongyu Zhou, **Yihao Dong**, Masahiko Inami, Zhanna Sarsenbayeva, and Anusha Withana. 2025. A Survey on Methodological Approaches to Collaborative Embodiment in Virtual Reality. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2507.18877 (July 2025)*. <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2507.18877>

EXPERIENCES

Associate Lecturer (PhD Teaching Fellow)

Oct 2025 - Present

The University of Sydney, Sydney, NSW

- Co-coordinate *COMP9001 Introduction to Programming*: Deliver foundational programming concepts using Python for a postgraduate-level cohort.
- Co-coordinate *COMP9123 Data Structures and Algorithms*: Instruct postgraduate students on core algorithmic paradigms, focusing on computational efficiency and optimized problem-solving strategies.

Guest Lecturer (Human-Computer Interaction)

June 2025

The University of Sydney, Sydney, NSW

- Delivered a specialized lecture on contemporary Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) research methodologies and emerging trends.
- Presented original research on haptic feedback and sensory augmentation, demonstrating the practical application of usability principles in extended reality (XR) and assistive technologies.

Casual Academic

June 2023 - Present

The University of Sydney, Sydney, NSW

Honours Project Examiner

- INFO4999 Computer Science Honours S2, 2025 S2 2024

TA (Head Tutor)

- COMP5427 Usability Engineering S1 2025
- INFO3315 Human-Computer Interaction S2 2025

Tutor

- ISYS2120 Data and Information Management S2 2023, S2 2024
- COMP5338 Advanced Data Models S2 2024
- INFO3315 Human-Computer Interaction S1 2025, S2 2024
- Conducted tutorial sessions for various classes, both with and without specific guidelines or instructions.

- Engaged in regular meetings with student groups to offer ongoing formative feedback on their assignments on a weekly basis.
- Evaluated a diverse range of assignments, encompassing reports, code projects, and websites.
- Delivered insightful and constructive feedback to students to enhance their understanding and foster their academic progress.

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Peer-Reviewing:

External Reviewer: CHI 2026, ISMAR 2026

Conferences and Symposia:

Student Volunteer: AHs 2025

AWARDS

Honorable Mention Award

CHI 2025 (Top 5% of submissions)

2025

Best Early PhD Project, School of Computer Science Research Showcase
the University of Sydney

2025

Faculty of Engineering Research Scholarship
the University of Sydney

2024 - 2028

CORE QUALIFICATIONS

- Advanced Programming Skills: Python, Java, JavaScript, SQL, R
- Website Design, Development and Backend Maintenance
- Data and Information Analysis and Management
- Analysis, Design and Optimize Computer Algorithms
- Analysis, Evaluate and Reengineer Business Processes
- Design, Develop and Manage Projects in Practice
- Experienced with Key Development and Design Methodologies

PROFESSIONAL RELEVANT SKILLS

- Working in High Performing Team
- Communication and Presentation
- Time Management and Multitasking
- Adaptability and Flexibility
- Relationship Building and Management
- Critical Thinking and Problem-Solving

LANGUAGES

- **English**
Professional Working Proficiency
- **Chinese, Mandarin**
Native

ACADEMIC REFERENCES

- Anusha Withana (anusha.withana@sydney.edu.au)
- Craig.Jin (craig.jin@sydney.edu.au)
- Howe Zhu (howe.zhu@sydney.edu.au)
- Zhanna Sarsenbayeva (zhanna.sarsenbayeva@sydney.edu.au)